



K. BHAGYA PRAKASH

Advani outwits Causier to retain CCI billiards crown



World champion Pankaj Advani continued his impressive run as he thrashed Englishman David Causier 1836-743 in a lopsided final to retain the All India CCI Billiards Classic title.

Advani was in outstanding form as he constructed two big breaks of 801 and 460 to outwit Causier, a former 10-time world champion, in the four-hour summit clash played at the CCI's Wilson Jones billiards hall.

This was Advani's fourth successive triumph at this venue. He claimed the CCI Snooker Classic over the last two years and now retains the billiards title.

In workmanlike fashion, Advani went about his task of building those massive breaks that knocked the fight out of his rival.

The Bengaluru-based cueist, who has 27 world titles, showcased his artistry as he executed his shots with a silken touch and a high degree of precision and consistency.

Advani was presented with the winners' trophy and a cash prize of Rs. 2,50,000, while Causier was awarded a cheque of Rs. 1,25,000 and the runner-up trophy.

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1 The Federation Cup wrestling tournament will be held in Varanasi from April 24 to 26. According to a notification from the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI), participating states will be eligible to send entries in all three styles — freestyle, Greco Roman and women. The WFI has given wild card entries to 10 units, including several non-traditional states, apparently including the wrestlers who competed in the Jaipur Nationals conducted by the Indian Olympic Association's appointed ad hoc committee in select categories.

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2 Defending champion Lyca Kovai Kings and Chepauk Super Gillies will kickstart the eighth edition of the Tamil Nadu Premier League on July 5 in Salem. As in the previous two years, the TNPL will follow a caravan format, with the first leg to be held in Salem (July 5-11), followed by Coimbatore (July 13-18), Tirunelveli (July 20-24), and Dindigul (July 26-28). Dindigul will also host the first two playoff games (Qualifier-1 and Eliminator on July 30 and 31, respectively), while Chennai will host Qualifier-2 on August 2 and the final on August 4.

S. DIPAK RAGAV